

SYLLABUS
Paper - II

UNIT - I - Interview Skills

1. GROUP DISCUSSION, INTERVIEW SKILLS
2. BODY LANGUAGE
3. SELF INTRODUCTION

UNIT - II - Writing Skills

1. RESUME WRITING AND COVER LETTER
2. E-MAIL WRITING
3. ESSAY WRITING

UNIT - III - Reading Skills

1. JUMBLED SENTENCES
2. READING COMPREHENSION
3. CLOZE TEST

Activities:

1. Story Retelling
2. Listen and Repeat
3. Read out loud
4. Jumbled Sentences
5. Mock Interviews
6. Verb Formation Questions

TEXT:

Alex.K Soft Skills, S. Chand, New Delhi. 2011 ISBN: 81-219-3192-4

REFERENCE:

1. Kumar, Sanjay. Pushpalata. Communication Skills. Oxford University Press, 2023. ISBN: 978-0-19-945706-9
2. Sharma, R. C, & Mohan, Krishna. Business Correspondence and Report Writing: A Practical Approach to Business and Technical Communication. Fifth Edition, McGraw Hill Education Pvt. Ltd, Chennai, 2018 ISBN: 978-93-85965-05-0.

MODEL PAPER

Section-A

Answer any **THREE** of the following questions.

3x5=15 M

1. Write a note on Do's of group discussion.
2. What is meant by Kinesics? Give details.
3. What is skimming? When do we use it?
4. How do you prepare for an interview?
5. What is the importance of E-mail correspondence?

Section-B

Answer any **TWO** of the following questions.

2x10=20 M

1. Write a cover letter and prepare your own resume for the post of Accountant in Reliance Digitals.
2. What are the practical hints when you are attending the interview?
3. Write about the different types of essays with examples.
4. a) Rearrange the following words/phrases to form meaningful sentences. ~~5/13~~
 1. of leather / The jacket / was made
 2. sipped / some water / The sparrow
 3. the computer / is working on / My neighbor
 4. our gratitude / to show / We have / to them
 5. If you work hard, / surely / you will / succeed

b) Skim the following paragraph and answer the questions: ~~2/13~~

Here's something to think about the next time you go shopping. Have you ever noticed how many trolleys are available when you go to the supermarket? In my experience, it seems like hundreds! But how about the number of hand baskets? Invariably I struggle to find even one, especially when I only need a few items. Why might this be the case? Well it seems to be a tactic used to encourage us to buy more. If you are walking around with an empty trolley, you are more tempted to fill it, so if you are planning on only doing a quick shop, always try to find a basket. It will be lighter, easier to use and is sure to save you money!

1. What can you find in large numbers at a supermarket? You can always find large numbers of trolleys at a supermarket.
2. Why can this be a problem? It can be a problem because you might only want a few things but be tempted to buy more because of the room in the trolley.
3. How can you avoid spending more than you planned if you only need a few items? Always try to use a shopping basket instead of a trolley.
4. Why is it a good idea to use a basket instead of a trolley? It is a good idea because a basket is lighter, easier to use and even may save money.
5. Does the passage recommend using trolley?

UNIT - I, INTERVIEW SKILLS

1. GROUP DISCUSSION

1.1 Definition

The term Group Discussion (GD) is used to refer to an oral communication situation in which a small number of professionals meet and discuss a problem or issue to arrive at a consensus or to exchange information on a significant matter related to the function, growth or expansion of the organisation to which they belong. The purpose of the discussion is to elicit the views of all participants and through intense interaction evolve a consensus.

Process

In a group discussion there is no chairperson, no secretary, and no detailed agenda, hence it is not structured. Only the problem or issue is stated and any member can initiate the discussion and deal with any aspect. Any member in the group can give a preview of what points are likely to arise, provide an internal summary of the views expressed up to a point of time and summarise the discussion towards the end. However, it is the duty of each member to ensure that the discussion proceeds smoothly leading to a solution. Obviously, display of anger, emotion and excitement has no place in a group discussion. The participants generally sit in a circle round a table so that each participant is able to observe the expression and make eye contact with the others.

A group discussion is used to help reveal multiple aspects of one's personality and soft skills. Some of these are as follows:

1. Ability to work as a team
2. Communication skills, including active listening
3. Non-Verbal Communication
4. Leadership and assertiveness
5. Innovation, creativity and lateral thinking
6. Flexibility
7. Reasoning
8. Ability to influence
9. Inter-personal Skills
10. Group dynamics
11. Decision making and problem solving
12. Presentation Skills
13. Spontaneity
14. Organizational Skills
15. Management Skills

Structure of a group discussion

Group discussion consists of three essential elements namely, initiation, body, and conclusive remarks, i.e. Summary.

Initiation: If you are thorough with the topic, initiate the discussion by reciting a powerful quote or definition, statement or attractive sentence, relevant to the topic and then start the main part of the body. If you are apprehensive, then allow others to initiate the discussion, follow them carefully and then take part in the discussion, you must not initiate the topic if you are not certain about your knowledge levels. A good initiation grabs good points.

Body: The main body must possess few important points namely, knowledge, facts and figures, data and statistics, logical interpretation, popular statements. You must possess and

exhibit the required skills set in the group discussion and demonstrate your maturity and authority levels.

Summary: A vast majority of the group topics does not require conclusion, you are required to express your point of view, keeping in view the merits of natural justice and the expression must be brief and concise, you must stick to the summary of the salient points only, the summary be task oriented which must not give scope for further debate, so do not pass a controversial statement, arrive at a consensus, be fair, open and straight. The summary fetches you good marks if it is appealing and impressive.

Do's and Don'ts of Group Discussion

As a student and later as a professional you may have to take part in a group discussion. Your effectiveness would depend upon whether you possess the personality traits mentioned earlier. Try to cultivate them if you do not possess any and sharpen the ones you already have. The quality of your performance would improve if you follow the guidelines given below in the form of DO's and DON'Ts.

Do's

1. Define the topic or the issue.
2. Analyze its scope and implications.
3. Initiate and generate the discussion.
4. Listen to the views of others intently. *cooper attention*
5. Encourage and provide reticent members to speak. *cool and formal*
6. Intervene forcefully but politely, when the situation demands.
7. Summarize views of the others before presenting your point of view.
8. Be brief and to the point in the presentation of your views.
9. Concede to others' points of view, if they are reasonable.
10. Try to lead the group to a definite conclusion.
11. Emphasize the points you consider significant.
12. Look at, and address, all the members of the group.
13. Speak with proper pronunciation.
14. Help the group conclude the discussion within the allotted time (usually an hour or
15. Maintain a relaxed and pleasant atmosphere throughout the discussion.
16. Summarise the main view-points at the end.
17. State the conclusions reached.

Don'ts

1. Don't be assertive in presenting your views.
2. Don't dominate the discussion.
3. Don't monopolise the discussion.
4. Don't make any personal remarks.
5. Don't jump to conclusions.
6. Don't enter into dyadic discussion.
7. Don't speak continuously for a long time.
8. Neither raise your voice too high nor speak too softly.
9. Don't speak in monotone.
10. Avoid using speech mannerisms and time-fillers.
11. Don't use aggressive gestures.
12. Neither recline in your chair nor lean forward.
13. Don't ignore any member of the group.

GROUP DISCUSSION AND CAMPUS INTERVIEW

Step One: The members of the selection panel give a talk in which they present a profile of the company, a description of the job offered and the package of compensation.

Step Two: The talk is followed by an aptitude test to find out the suitability of the mindset of the candidates for the job.

Step Three: Those who qualify in the aptitude test are required to participate in a GD. Its purpose is not so much to test in the aptitude test of knowledge about the topic group. Observe the participants' group behaviour and the quality of their interaction within the group.

Step Four: Those whose performance is up to the mark are then invited to appear in what called a technical interview. Here an attempt is made to find out the extent of technical knowledge and skills required for the job. The questions are generally based on contents of the discipline courses done by the interviewee.

Step Five: All those who appear in the technical interview have to appear in Human Resources (HR) interview. It is a sort of oral personality test. Its purpose is to find out whether the interviewee possesses soft skills and also whether he has the potential to grow quickly and imbibe the relevant skills and work culture of the organisation within a short time.

INTERVIEW SKILLS

Job interview has become a crucial component of the selection process in any industry. An interview is a formal conversation between an interviewer and interviewee where the former seeks answers from the latter, which checks their capability in joining the desired post. Just as an interviewee wants a job befitting his eligibility, the interviewer is also keen on recruiting an employee who will be an asset to his organization. The interviewer wants to find out if the candidate being interviewed has the hard skills and the personality traits to be the chosen man for the specific job. The interviewee, on the other hand, gets an opportunity to ascertain if the particular job will be suitable for him. Hence, interviews have gained in importance, and different types of interviews are arranged to evaluate a candidate for a job from different perspectives.

Types of Interviews

There are different types of interviews according to different scenarios or situations. Here it is categorized into nine major types.

1. Structured Interview
2. Unstructured Interview
3. Stress Interview
4. One to One Interview
5. Panel Interview
6. Telephonic Interview
7. Video Interview
8. Depth Interview
9. Open Call Interview
10. Exit Interview

1. Structured Interview

It is the traditional form of an interview. Preset standardized questions are asked from the interviewee and are the same for all the candidates.

- It is the kind of interview that gives the chance to examine all the candidates' skills and abilities impartially.
- The questions also help the interviewer to compare the responses and to choose the best.

2. Unstructured Interview

It is just the opposite of structured interviews. It is a free-flowing conversation. This type of interview is also known as Informal interview.

- The interviewer already has a definite idea in mind about the questions to be asked.
- Generally, questions are made and asked during the interview.
- The questions can change according to the responses the candidate gives.
- An unstructured interview does not follow any formal rules and procedures.

3. Stress Interview

These kinds of interviews are very rare. In this, the interviewer puts the interviewee under a stressful situation to test their presence of mind.

- Stress interview also tests how interviewee manage the crisis at a given time.
- The interviewer tends to make the interviewee nervous by asking tons of questions at the same time.
- It is done to see whether the candidate can cope up with a crisis and not panic.

4. One to One Interview

It is a general interview. There are just two persons, i.e., the interviewer and the interviewee, and a formal discussion takes place face to face about the candidate's skills and abilities.

The interviewer asks general and technical questions to check the suitability.

5. Panel Interview

A panel interview is known as a board interview; the interview takes place between one candidate and a panel of members of the company, usually more than two.

- Each one gives different scores to the candidates and combines them to see if the candidate is qualified.
- Further, in a panel interview, candidates are often victims of personal biases, and it is not feasible for organizations that take many interviews daily.

6. Telephonic Interview

Telephonic interviews are conducted over the phone and are economical and less time-consuming. Through these interviews, the company can select promising individuals for the job.

- Its main objective is to limit the list of candidates and appoint the best ones.
- These are more accurate than one to one interviews for judging interviewees' intelligence and interpersonal skills.
- The candidates are usually surprised by the unexpected call from the recruiter.
- However, they have a drawback; just as the candidate will be surprised, they likely can be panicked.
- Moreover, answers are to be given in a restricted time.

7. Video Interview

One of the newest forms of interviews is conducted through various video conferences, online chats, or messaging due to their rapidity and inexpensiveness. It saves time and money.

- The best part of these interviews is that both the interviewer and interviewee need not be in the same place, not even the same continent.

- It is just like a personal interview where the recruiter informs you about the interview a few hours before the scheduled time.
- These interviews are done if the interviewee lives far-off and cannot make it to the interviewer's place for valid reasons.

8. Depth Interview

As the term itself says, it distinguishes the interviewee in-depth. These are detail and discovery-oriented.

- It covers the candidate's life history, academic qualifications, interests, hobbies, and professional work experience.
- The interviewer here is a listener and wants to know in detail about the candidates, allowing more time and a free flow of conversation and making a friendly approach.

9. Open Call Interview

Open call interviews, most commonly known as walk-in interviews, are conducted on the spot, and the questions are not preset. The questions vary according to the response of the candidates. Most of these types of interviews are for seasonal or temporary job roles.

10. Exit Interview

These interviews are conducted with an employee of a company when they are leaving their job. In this interview, the employee is expected to deliver an honest review of his experience in the firm. Its main purpose is to give a good feeling to the person leaving and take suggestions offered by them.

Interview Dos and Don'ts

Do ...

- Decrease your stress. Remind yourself that the interview will be more of a conversation rather than an interrogation.
- ✓ Prepare some anecdotes. Be ready to talk about your interests, skills, and experiences – your career story – and provide examples from your life that demonstrate your professional and behavioural capabilities.
- ✓ Arrive 10 minutes early. No more, no less. Late attendance is never excusable. Arriving too early may be seen as an intrusion for those who aren't ready to receive you.
- ✓ Check your appearance (teeth, hair, clothes) prior to the interview.
- Shake hands with everyone you meet during the interview.
- Choose to sit in a chair rather than on a couch for better interview posture.
- Rise from your chair to shake hands with and greet new people who enter the room to join the interview.
- Truthfully, professionally, and directly answer questions. Be sure you answer the questions the interviewer really asks rather than ones you feel more confident answering. Never use negative language when discussing a previous work experience.
- Get the interviewer to describe the position and responsibilities early in the conversation so you can relate your skills and your background to the position throughout the interview.
- Discuss your qualifications. Stress accomplishments that are most pertinent to the job.
- Positively conduct yourself. Smile, make eye contact, nod occasionally to indicate understanding/agreement, don't slouch, and maintain your composure.
- Dress appropriately. Even if casual dress is common to the workplace, dress up for the interview.

- Ask questions throughout the interview. Rather than a one-sided conversation, an interview should be a mutual exchange of information. The interviewer will appreciate not having to initiate all the dialogue.
- Listen. Concentrate not only on the interviewer's words, but also on his/her tone of voice and body language. Once you understand how an interviewer thinks, pattern your answers accordingly to better relate.

Don't ...

- Don't Interrupt the interviewer. If you don't have time to listen, neither will he/she.
- Don't Answer vague questions. Rather than answer puzzling questions, kindly ask the interviewer for clarification and then respond.
- Don't Smoke, chew gum, or place anything on the interviewer's desk.
- Don't Be overly familiar (address by first names, joke excessively, give pats on the back, etc.) even if the interviewer demonstrates familiarity.
- Don't Wear heavy perfume or cologne.
- Don't Ramble. Long answers can sound apologetic, indecisive, or unfocused in your thinking. Conversely, avoid answering questions with a laconic "yes" or "no." Support your answers with brief, specific anecdotes from your employment history.
- Don't Consume alcoholic beverages or order expensive entrees if the interview comprises lunch or dinner.

Communication Skills are Essential to attend an interview

Communication skills are essential in any job interview as they help you to express yourself clearly, understand the interviewer's questions, and demonstrate your suitability for the role. Good communication skills can set you apart from other candidates and increase your chances of being selected for the position. Here are some key subtopics related to communication skills:

1. Verbal Communication

Verbal communication involves using your voice to convey your message. This includes your tone of voice, volume, and clarity. In a job interview, it's important to speak clearly and confidently, using a tone of voice that is friendly and professional.

2. Non verbal Communication

Nonverbal communication includes your body language, facial expressions, and gestures. It's important to maintain good eye contact with the interviewer, sit up straight, and avoid fidgeting or other distracting behaviors.

3. Active Listening

Active listening involves paying attention to the interviewer's questions, asking for clarification when necessary, and responding thoughtfully. This aspect is very important in proving that you are engaged and interested in the position.

4. Concise and Clear Messaging

Being concise and clear in your messaging is important when answering questions in a job interview. Avoid rambling or going off on tangents, and focus on answering the question directly and succinctly.

5. Empathy and Interpersonal Skills

Empathy and interpersonal skills involve being able to relate to others, understand their perspective, and work collaboratively. These skills are important in a job interview, as they show that you are capable of working well with others and can contribute to a positive work environment.

6. Cultural Awareness

Cultural awareness involves being able to communicate effectively with people from different backgrounds and cultures. This is important in a globalized work environment and can demonstrate your ability to adapt and work well in diverse teams.

By mastering these communication skills, you can improve your chances of making a positive impression in a job interview and increase your likelihood of being selected for the position.

How to prepare for an interview (steps & tips)

1. Research the Company.
2. Review the Job Description.
3. Practice Your Answers.
4. Dress Appropriately
5. Arrive Early
6. Bring a Copy of Your Resume
7. Follow Up.
8. Listen Carefully
9. Be Authentic
10. Show Enthusiasm
11. Follow Professional Etiquette
12. Practice Good Posture
13. Showcase Your Accomplishments
14. Research the Interviewer
15. Be Prepared for Behavioral Questions
16. Be Prepared to Address Weaknesses
17. Show Gratitude
18. Maintain proper eye contact
19. Behave in a dignified and professional way
20. Exhibit good body language traits
21. Speak clearly using correct and meaningful words
22. Maintain dignity through-out the session
23. Use voice modulation to make the answers more appealing
24. Display skills set to the best of your ability
25. Thank the interviewer politely

2. BODY LANGUAGE

1.2 Body Language

Introduction:-

Body language is a non-verbal communication form, which refers to body movements, facial expression, smile, eye movements, posture, attitudes and gestures. Body language accounts for more than 90% of the information we communicate. It isn't, though, a universal truth. What therefore makes body language so crucial to communication? We accompany our speech with gestures, posture, and facial emotions. It enhances our message or effectively communicates the genuine meaning that our words cannot. Our body language is made up of a wide variety of nonverbal clues and indicators. Examples of nonverbal communication include gestures, tone of voice, body language, and facial expressions. The ability to read and understand these signs is crucial for effective communication. How Body Language Plays an Important Role in Communication?

Let's discuss why body language is significant in communicating now that you are familiar with what it is. Have you ever come across a group of chimpanzees in the wild? Observe how they communicate through non-verbal signs and body language. The fact that they communicate despite being unable to talk verbally is astounding.

Similar to animals, humans communicate through both vocal and nonverbal cues. Your body language, for instance, conveys how confident you are in the corporate world. More than you may realise, it is a sign of dedication. Additionally, the way that body language affects your personal brand is crucial.

Kinesics (The Language of Body)

In face to face interaction, body language plays an important role. We begin to form an impression about a speaker as soon as we see him. The way he is dressed, the manner in which he moves, stands, or sits all these give a significant clue to his personality, that is, the kind of person he is. It is only rarely that our impression is belied when he speaks. A systematic study of the movement of human body in the process of communication is called kinesics. A lot of research has been done in this area and the results published in the form of books. Here, we shall briefly discuss the main aspects of the personality which are significant from the communication point of view.

1. Personal Appearance The listeners would form their first impression about you from your personal appearance. You should, therefore, consider this aspect of your personality as part of the message you communicate. If you are properly dressed and look smart, you would induce among the listeners a receptive mood. They would form a favourable impression and become eager to listen to you.

Apparel oft proclaims the man' this is what Shakespeare said centuries ago but the statement holds good even today. The choice of your dress should suit the occasion. In general, a sober, simple, neat, formal and comfortable dress that you habitually wear would be all right for occasions such as personal interaction for a professional purpose, oral presentation, group discussion, interview, etc. If you are clean and well-groomed, a feeling of trust and expectancy would be generated and you would exude confidence and speak or interact with proper poise. And thus you would have already marched a few steps on the road to success in communication even before you start speaking.

2. Facial Expression Face is the most expressive part of the body. Its mobile features and the muscles express a number of feelings and emotions. They are used for a faithful reflection of thoughts and true feelings and sometimes also for a deliberate suppression of them. Thus,

face is not always the index of the mind. Shakespeare's statement supports this view: 'One may smile and smile and be a villain'.

The expression of certain basic emotions on the face is universal. For example, generally speaking, expanded lips and smiling eyes stand for happiness, pursed up lips, red eyes, and contracted eyebrows for anger, contracted eyelids and closed lips for sorrow, raised eyebrows for disapproval or disbelief, tightened jaw muscles for antagonism, etc. The language of the face is subtle and there are a variety of ways in which it can be manipulated. In fact, you can communicate a number of feelings or even mixed feelings in quick succession. You should, therefore be careful in reading the message being conveyed through the facial features. It would be advisable to confirm it by referring to the accompanying verbal message. When you interact with a person or with a group, you should maintain a cheerful expression on your face. It must reflect your confidence and zeal. If you do so, you would be able to establish a quick rapport with the audience and the going would be easy.

3. Eye Contact Eye contact is one of the most effective means of communicating non-verbal messages and establishing rapport with listeners. As you may be aware, eyes reflect several personality traits such as intelligence, sincerity, confidence, conviction, etc. Raised looks indicate dominance and downcast looks suggest weakness and submission. Rightly, therefore, they are said to be the windows of the inner self. In fact, direct eye-contact often enables a speaker to overcome nervousness and self-consciousness. You should learn to use these nuances of eye contact properly so as to make an effective and positive impact on the audience. When you have to speak before a group of people, look at them and pause for a while before you say anything. To start speaking as soon as one reaches the dais shows lack of poise and creates a poor impression on the audience.

While speaking, maintain eye contact with the entire audience, looking at one pair of eyes to another around the room. But do not gaze or stare at anybody. Further, to look at the ceiling or outside through a window or at one section of the audience is a sign of rudeness or nervousness. If listeners feel that you are ignoring them, it is most likely that they would turn a deaf ear to whatever you are saying.

Moreover, through eye contact you can get the signal whether the channel of communication is open and obtain the feedback-how the listeners are reacting to what you are saying. If they do not make a direct eye contact with you, they are probably not concentrating on your talk. It would then become necessary for you to change your strategy of presentation to win back their attention.

4. Movement: Movement from one place to another in front of a group of listeners also, to some extent, gives a clue about your personality and conveys a message about the kind of person you are. At the venue of speech you would be watched by the audience when you walk to the dais and from your seat to the place from where you have to speak, and when you move on the dais while speaking. You may have had the occasion to listen to some good speakers. Did they rush when invited to take their seat on the dais? Did they get up with a jerk before starting to speak? Did they move on the dais from side to side like a pendulum or forward and backward like a piston? If they did, do not emulate them even if they spoke well. You can do better by avoiding such awkward body movements. A general rule is: walk at normal speed with an upright posture and with proper poise. This would enable you to relieve tension, help you draw the attention of listeners and change the pace of presentation. If there is a question-answer session after your talk, you should answer from the place you are standing. You may, however, move a few steps towards the left or right side to get a little

nearer to the person who asked the question but do not go too close to the audience because this is a sign of being aggressive. When the session is over, walk back to your seat gracefully and watch the rest of the proceedings with equipoise.

5. Posture: Posture is the way you conduct yourself when you face an audience. The way you sit or stand reveals a lot about you. It may show the degree of your alertness, sense of purpose, confidence and self-image. The audience would begin to evaluate you even before you speak by observing your posture the way you sit on the dais, waiting to be called upon to speak. If you sit in a relaxed manner and look straight at the audience with a cheerful expression on your face, you would create a good initial impression. The listeners are likely to become eager to hear you and your task of speaking would become easier. On the other hand, if you play with your bunch of keys, pen, buttons, note-cards, etc., you would give the impression of being nervous and ill-organised. Your posture would generate a negative attitude towards you and this may hinder the smooth flow of communication.

While speaking, keep your note-cards on the lectern. If there is no lectern, hold them in your hand without trying to hide them from the audience. If your hands are free, let them hang on the sides or keep them on the lectern. Never put them on your belly or in your pockets. Stand tall and upright with your chin parallel to the ground, pause for a while, look at the entire audience and then start speaking. Do not slump or lean on the lectern. If there is a mike, keep your mouth about eight inches away from it.

To get feedback, keep on observing the audience. If you find quite a number of persons leaning backward and sitting with crossed arms, you should change the strategy of presentation because such postures indicate that they are not interested in listening to you. On the other hand, if they are leaning forward and sitting with uncrossed arms, you can safely conclude that they are interested or eager to listen to you. After you have finished speaking, walk back to your seat with the same grace which you reflected when you went to the podium to start speaking.

6. Gesture In the present content, the term gesture refers to the movement of any part of the body such as hands, arms, fingers, head, shoulders, etc., to convey, reinforce or illustrate meaning. If you observe carefully, you can discern a regular pattern in the use of gestures. Speaking without any gesture is difficult. And if a person deliberately sits or stands like a statue while speaking, the impact of his speech would certainly be lost. Some gestures are culture-specific. For example, in our society the moving of head downwards (nod) means acceptance or agreement whereas moving it from side to side amounts to saying 'no' to a suggestion or proposal. In some Western countries it is just the reverse. In USA, pounding the table with a clenched fist is a sign of anger or emphasis whereas in the eastern countries it would be considered rude and a sign of bad manners. Embracing a person when introduced is considered to be an expression of warmth in some Arab countries but in the West it is viewed with displeasure. Though gestures generally accompany speech, sometimes they are used by themselves to convey meaning. For example, by using gestures you can easily communicate 'yes', 'no', 'come', 'go', etc., without using a single word. If you have watched a mime show, you may have been amazed at the ingenuity of actor's to express many meanings, some of them very complex, merely by gestures.

Though there are hundreds of gestures that accompany speech, the main ones can be classified into the following five categories:

1. Enumerative
2. Descriptive
3. Locative
4. Symbolic
5. Emphatic

The enumerative gesture is elementary and the easiest to use. This is done by raising as many fingers as the number being enumerated. Obviously, this gesture is of limited value because it cannot be used for large numbers. In the descriptive gesture, the hands are used to show the size and shape of things being referred to in speech. The direction and movement of an object can also be indicated by this gesture. To point out the location of an object or area, locative gestures are used. For example, you may use your index finger to refer to the location of an object. Or you may use your thumb to indicate the location of something behind you. For conveying an idea or notion to the audience, symbolic gesture is used. For example, you may clasp your hands together to convey the notion of unity or cooperation. A symbolic gesture which is widely used is making the letter V (as a sign of victory) by using the index and middle finger. The emphatic gesture is used to emphasize an idea or to express determination. An example of this gesture is raising the right hand with clenched fist, and moving it forward and backward in quick succession to reflect determination.

There are certain gestural mannerisms such as blinking the eyes, raising the eyebrows or shrugging the shoulders unnecessarily, which impede effective communication. It is, therefore, necessary to check whether the gestures you make while speaking are appropriate or not.

3. SELF INTRODUCTION

1.3 Self Introduction:

Learning how to introduce yourself in English will guarantee that you start off on the right foot in every situation. While there are different ways to introduce yourself in different situations, there are tips and tricks that you can learn to introduce yourself in both professional and social situations. In this blog, we'll take you through the best ways to introduce yourself in English.

Unfortunately, textbooks and language classes often fail us. They teach us how to introduce ourselves in forced and unnatural ways. There are only a few scenarios where you'll need to ramble off as much information about yourself as possible in a few short minutes. Keep reading to learn some new and interesting ideas and sound like a native English speaker when you introduce yourself in different scenarios.

What Does Your Self-Introduction For the Interview Require To Cover?

1. Your Details. Provide your name, where you're from, and any other relevant personal information ...
2. Qualifications. ...
3. Work Experience. ...
4. Outside Interests. ...
5. Your Values. ...
6. Future Plan

What Do Interviewers Expect in Your Self-Introduction?
Remember that interviewers have no interest in your personal life. In a job interview, recruiters are only interested in evaluating your confidence, social, and communication skills to determine whether you are a good fit for the organization and the role you are applying for. Keep your self-introduction brief and professional. Ideally, your self-introduction should not be longer than a minute.

Things to Avoid During Self-Introduction
Remember to follow the steps mentioned to avoid a negative impression in the first answer, self-introduction.

- Avoid enlisting your skills. Rather, tell the skills with demonstrated examples.
- Do not end up reciting your entire resume. Keep the introduction short and to the point.
- Prepare the introduction beforehand. Refrain from thinking abruptly and answer missing key details.
- Be relaxed and introduce professional experience or skills beneficial to the company.
- Do not repeat the resume. Add examples of tools, techniques, software, extra-curricular activities, extra learnings, and interests.
- Exclude skills unrelated to the applied role.

1. What information should I include in my introduction?

It's crucial to convey who you are, what you do professionally, and why you're a suitable candidate for the role you're interviewing for. Include a brief overview of your educational qualifications and professional experience, focusing on roles, responsibilities, and achievements relevant to the position at hand. Additionally, it's advantageous to present your motivations for applying, highlighting your understanding of the company's values, culture, and business objectives. However, keep this introduction concise and engaging, leaving room for further exploration of these topics throughout the interview. Your introduction in an interview should be succinct and last around 1 to 2 minutes. Provide your name, educational background, relevant work experience, key skills, and strengths. Convey your career objective and express gratitude for the opportunity.

2. What is the best answer to 'Tell me about yourself'?

The best answer for "Tell me about yourself" is a concise and focused summary that highlights your relevant work experience, key skills, and accomplishments. Start with a brief introduction of your name and current role, then provide a concise overview of your professional background, mentioning a few career highlights that align with the job you're applying for. Avoid personal details and keep the response professional and job-oriented, setting a positive tone for the rest of the interview.

Exercise

When we see someone giving the most engaging, impressive and rapport-building introduction, we immediately think they're gifted. This section will help you learn introduce yourself and learn how to respond to introductions. You will also learn how to introduce people to one another (introducing two people who are strangers to each other. List of expressions or phrases used to introduce yourself and to introduce people one another.

Beginning an Introduction

✓ Let me introduce myself.
I just wanted to introduce myself. I am....
I don't think we've met before. My name's...
Have we met before?
Hello....how are you?
✓ My name is...
✓ Nice to meet you.
Nice to meet you too.
Pleasure to meet you.
Pleased to meet you.
This is....
✓ I'd like to introduce you to....
✓ I'd like you to meet....
I don't think you've met....
I don't think you know.... May I introduce you to...

Furthering a conversation

What do you do?
Where do you work? What brings you here?
Where are you from?
How old are you?
What kind of hobbies do you have?

Ending an Introduction

It was nice meeting you.
Very nice meeting you.
I hope to see you soon.
Let's keep in touch.
We will meet up sometime next week?
Take care!
Goodbye/bye.
See you.
I catch you later.
It has been a pleasure, we'll meet again soon.
Catch you later.
It has been a pleasure, we'll meet again soon.

INTRODUCING YOURSELF

Introducing yourself is much more than saying your name; it is a way to connect with someone you do not know. Introducing yourself to strangers can be tricky because what you say depends entirely on the context. You might have to introduce yourself differently depending on

whether you are addressing an audience before you give a speech, meet someone at a networking event, or starting a conversation with an unfamiliar person at a party. It is important to introduce yourself in a way that is appropriate and which will make people like and remember you.

Dialogue 1

(Mrs Sharada Rao introduces herself to Mr Abhishek Naidu, an employee in the college, where she has just started work)

Ms Shanada : Good morning! I'm Sharada Rao, I've joined the college today as an Assistant Professor, Department of English. I was teaching private tuitions for UG courses in Vijayawada earlier.

Mr. Abhishek : Good morning! I'm happy to meet you. I'm Abhishek Naidu, and I'm an Administration Officer in this college. Welcome to our college!

Shanada: Thank you. Mr Abhishek. Very nice meeting you too.

Dialogue 2

(Two strangers at a conference hall, introduce themselves to each other.)

Gita : The Conference this year is very good, isn't it?

Lata: Yes, I'm really enjoying it. I think it's better than last year's. Did you come last year?

Gita: No, I didn't. But I came the year before, and that one wasn't as good as this year's.

Lata: The speakers this year are a lot better. And so is the food!

Gita : Allow me to introduce myself. My name's Gita Madhuri

Lata: Pleased to meet you, Gita. My name's Lata Rao. (they shake hands.) Gita Pleased to meet you, too. How long will you be at the conference?

Lata: I'm here all five days. And you?

Gita: I'm here for only three days. I'm leaving the day after tomorrow.

Lata: What do you do?

Gita: I'm a sales manager at 'Image India'. And you?

Lata: I'm the director of marketing for an internet company called "Travelquick".

Dialogue 3

(Person introduces himself to a new colleague in his office.)

Pradeep: I don't think we've been introduced. My name's Pradeep. I work in the accounts department.

Prashant : Nice to meet you, Pradeep. I'm Prashant. (they shake hands.)

Pradeep : Hello Prashant; nice meeting you, too. Welcome to Travelquick. How's your first day at work?

Prashant: It's going very well. There's a lot to learn, but this job is similar to my last job. The people here seem very friendly.

Pradeep : We're glad to have you with us.

Prashant : Thank you. I look forward to working here.

UNIT-11. WRITING SKILLS

1. RESUME WRITING AND COVER LETTER

2.1 FOUR BASIC TYPES OF RESUMES

According to CareerBuilder, 39% of hiring managers spend less than a minute reading a resume and 23% only spend under 30 seconds looking over a document. This is why it's important to pick the resume that best suits your needs and showcases the most important aspects of your candidacy front and center. The following are the four basic types of resumes and the job for which you are applying:

- ① Chronological Resume
- ② Functional Resume
- ③ Combination Resume
- ④ Targeted Resume

① Chronological Resumes

A chronological resume is a very common type of resume and just as the name suggests, each section lists the presented items in chronological order or by date. Mostly, this type of resume is ideal for those with a solid, gap-free work history in line with the type of job for which you're applying. The "Work History" or "Professional Experience" sections of this type of resume are the most pronounced and span between eight to ten years depending on the number of years at your prior institutions. Start with your most recent position and work backward listing both dates and responsibilities. It is not necessary to go back ten years unless the experience is relevant to your job search.

② Functional Resume

Consider writing a functional resume if you're changing careers/^{strong in form - / construction} or graduating from college and your work history relating to the job you want is not as robust as you'd like. Functional resumes tend to highlight skills and their application relating to the job description vs. where and when you were previously employed doing the type of job for which you are applying. For example, CompTIA A+, CompTIA Network+, and CompTIA Security+ certifications are the first step to breaking into a career in IT. You may have tons of volunteer or hands-on hours from training like Computer Coach, but not much paid work history. When building a functional resume, you will list these skills and certifications first and how you have used them in practical situations while highlighting how you could use them in a paid position.

③ Combination Resume

Just as the name suggests, this resume type is a combination of both chronological and functional. Typically, this means that both a robust work history and a built-out skills section are listed within the resume. Creating a combination resume is easier with significant work and education experience. You can generally start your resume with the job titles you are seeking. Write out a robust professional summary and skills section, then include a chronological work history. Toward the bottom of the resume, you can include your education and skills training.

④ Targeted Resume

A targeted resume can be chronological, functional, or a combination but is "targeted" specifically to the position for which you are applying. The sections for work history, skills, and education are carefully constructed to emphasize the job requirements using exact keyword matching from the description. You will be required to research the company's

mission statement or vision as well as company culture and mirror those beliefs genuinely. You also want to consider that 98% of Fortune 500 companies use Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) to filter out ineffective resumes, as reported by Jobscan. This is why a targeted resume is especially helpful when applying online to help you overcome or rank higher in the ATS used by companies today.

Tips for writing a great resume

Consider using the following techniques as you approach writing your resume.

- ^{make according to requirements/specifications} **Customize your resume for each position you are applying for.** Use your summary or profile section to **highlight** your skills and expertise as they relate to the specific job. Better yet, carry this customization throughout the entire resume.
- **Make sure the rest of your resume supports your summary, profile, or objective.** If you include in your summary that you have been a **consistent top seller for your region**, you should include specific examples in the body of your resume to reinforce this statement.
- ^{humble feeling quality of doing} **Humility is a virtue.** Stating one's strengths should be done in a modest manner so that it is not construed as being arrogant.
- **Include key words on your resume.** Keep the job description close by when you are customizing your resume so you are including key words and phrases that fit the job, field, or occupation. Recruiters often look for key words that show you have the skills and knowledge required for the position.
- **Be concise.** Because some recruiters look at as many as 500 resumes to fill one position, they want to see your accomplishments, skills, and experiences in as few words as possible. Bullet points and concise language can showcase your communication skills while highlighting your areas of expertise.
- **Eliminate all irrelevant points** that do not speak for you loudly enough. Your main task is to convincingly focus on your strengths.
- **List your past work accomplishments (not just your responsibilities) using some form of measures.** Hiring managers want to compare your skills and abilities to the other candidates they are considering. For example, tell them what percentage you increased in sales, the number of staff you managed, or the specific scope of a project.
- **Show a balance of strengths and weaknesses.**

Consider using the following techniques as you approach the design of your resume.

- **Use white space and bullet points to help emphasize what you want the hiring manager to know about you.** If the hiring manager is scanning to see if you meet the requirements but can't easily spot the information, you may get overlooked.
- **Use bold and italics** to emphasize key words or skills. Be careful to not overuse this technique, though. If there are too many elements in bold or italics, the emphasis is lost.

- Use a **larger-point font** for headings and subheadings. This can help direct attention to certain areas of your resume and also demonstrates a strong level of organization.
- Use a **conservative font**, like Times New Roman, Arial, or Tahoma. If the font is difficult to read, your resume may not get past the first look.
- Include **adequate white space**. This can be done around your headings, blocks of text, and with margins. Hiring managers can use this area to take notes before, during, or after an interview.

Along with formatting your presentation, be sure to carefully edit your text. Consider these tips.

- Use **verb tense consistently**. For your present job, you can use the present tense, such as **design and oversee production of building additions**. For previous employment, use the past tense (**designed and oversaw**).
- **Vary your word choice**. Even though you are trying to include key words, don't overdo it. If the key phrase you are trying to include is **strategic planning**, use a thesaurus to find alternative words, like **defined program goals and measures**.
- **Spell check, spell check, spell check!** Almost every recruiter and hiring manager has a story about the resume they threw out because of a misspelled word. Typos and misspelled words show that you are not detail oriented or conscientious about your work. However, do not rely on your spell-checking software alone. Some grammar and spelling mistakes can be easily missed.

Common resume mistakes to avoid or don'ts for writing resume

There are several reasons hiring managers consistently put resumes in the No pile. You want to avoid these common mistakes.

- ✦ **Don't submit your resume for a position for which you are not qualified.** This was cited as the No. 1 pet peeve among HR professionals on a recent LinkedIn discussion. Make sure you meet at least the basic requirements. Think creatively, though, because sometimes the work you have performed outside of the field may help you meet job requirements.
- ✦ **Don't lie.** Whether or not it's intentional, including false, inaccurate, or misleading information brings your ethics into question and can even be illegal. Keep in mind that hiring managers are much more likely to Google and/or conduct background checks on candidates to eliminate dishonest ones.
- **Don't disregard references.** While you do not need to post your reference information on your resume, you should at least have them listed in a separate document that can be easily supplied if requested. Make sure your references are willing and ready to discuss your skills and abilities with a potential employer.
- ✦ **Don't use more than two fonts.** This can make a document difficult to read. The reader's eye needs familiar and easy-to-read fonts, like Times New Roman and Tahoma.
- ✦ **Don't use clip art on your resume.** ^{ready-made pieces} Clip art is not generally considered professional, and any style or formatting design should be minimal. However, if you are applying for a job in a creative industry, then showcasing your design abilities on your resume may be more acceptable and appealing.

- ✍ **Don't include pictures.** Unless it is required for the position, your photo is not necessary.
- ✍ **Don't include personal or health-related information.** This includes your birth date, height and weight, health or marital status, religion, or affiliations in clubs that are not related to your career. While it may be appropriate in other cultures and for certain jobs, personal information should generally not be included if you are submitting a resume for a job in the United States.
- ✍ **Don't include salary information** unless you are specifically asked to do so.
- ✍ **Don't misspell anything.** Misspelling words, especially words about the position, make you appear careless and unreliable. Use a spell checker, and have at least two other people proofread your resume for typos and errors.
- can open you up to negative comments or feedback that potential employers can read.
- ✍ **Online professional profiles,** such as LinkedIn, offer the advantages of highlighting your expertise, posting related links, and offering recommendations from colleagues all conveniently located in one spot. However, you should once again consider that the social interactive nature of profiles makes it difficult to control all of the content on your page, which may make you vulnerable to content you would not like a potential employer to read.
- **Online social media sites** like Twitter and Facebook should only be linked if you use them for professional branding and networking rather than for personal social interaction. Also, if you do not have much of a following on these sites, it will not be advantageous to include them. Only a professional profile with a strong following will portray you as an expert in your field.
- ✍ **Maintain an updated, professional, and polished site** if you are going to use one of these links on your resume. Make sure all content is grammatically correct. Create design and formatting that is professional and appealing. Remove all content that may be considered personal and/or inappropriate in nature.

RESUME SAMPLE FORMAT

Imran Ahmed

Kallu Street, Borsho Village & Post

RajjakMandal, Srikakulam (Dist).

Pin: 546156

EmailID: imranahmed@gmail.com

Mobile no: 9618362171

OBJECTIVE:

Seeking a challenging position in a quality and growth oriented environment, where knowledge and academic experience can be shared and enriched, looking forward to work challenging assignments.

adjusted or relation to surrounding

CERTIFICATION:

EDUCATION QUALIFICATIONS:

- Diploma in Electrical and Electronics Engineering (EEE) from Col. D.S Raj Polytechnic.
- Narmada, West Godavari. 82%
- ITI (Electrician) from Sri Sai ITI college, Godavari 86%
- SSC in XBY School Boddam 68%

PROJECT WORK:

- Industrial security system. @ Malaya systems, Palako

STRENGTHS:

- Sound inter personal skills & IQ level
- Interacting with different people for the discipline engineering.
- Positive attitude and self-confidence.
- Perseverance and decision making skills.
- Excellent typing skills *persistent determination.*

COMPUTER SKILLS:

- MS Office 2007
- Browsing,
- Internet.

HOBBIES

- Cricket
- Music

PERSONAL DETAILS:

Name: IMRAN AHMED

Date of Birth : 14th June, 1987

Father's Name : Mr. V.K Ahmed

Gender : Male

Marital Status: Single

Language Known: Telugu & English

Nationality: Indian

Permanent Address : Kallu Street, Borsho Village & Post

Rajjak Mandal Srikakulam (Dist).

Pin: 546156

Date:

Place:

(Imran Ahmed)

COVER LETTER SAMPLE FORMAT

303, Shanker Nagar
Nagapur- 440001

11 May 2014

The Managing Director

Bharat Fertilizers Ltd.

Tolstoy Marg

New Delhi-110001.

Dear Sir,

I have looked carefully at the job requirements of the Production Manager, advertised by your company in The Hindustan Times of 8 May 2006 and I feel confident that I possess the requisite qualifications and experience. I should feel grateful if you would kindly consider me for the post.

When I was doing courses in Chemical Engineering I got intensely interested in the production processes and ways of accelerating them. So I joined the MBA course and specialized in production management. I have had some success in evolving new techniques and processes of maximizing production. I am sure your expanding organisation will provide me further opportunities to make greater contribution in this field.

My salary at present is Rs 18,000/ p.m. and anything in the range of Rs 20,000/- to Rs 24,000 p.m. will be acceptable to me. In fact, I would have preferred this matter to be left entirely to you, had the advertisement not asked specifically about it.

I would very much appreciate your giving me a chance to be interviewed. I would then be able to give you further details about my work, which should help you in judging my suitability for the post.

Yours faithfully,

Subhash Gupta

Encl: Resume

2. E-MAIL WRITING

2. 2 What is Email?

The full form of Email is electronic mail. Gmail is an electronic mail service provider. You can send digital messages to anyone using email. Email is one of the oldest mediums of messaging. Today everyone is used email to send or receive messages, so an Email is one of the most popular messaging internet services. You can also receive messages from anyone by email. You can also easily send email like - text emails, photos, and videos to anyone by an Email. There is various use of email in day-to-day life.

Sameer Bhatiya

What are the Advantages of Email?

Email is the world's most popular communication tool.

It's Free

- Easy to Use
- Global
- Info at your Fingertips
- Send Reminders to yourself
- Speed
- Accessibility
- Without the Need for Paper
- Advertisements
- Attachments

1. It's Free

Email is a free service, that means anyone can use email without paying any money and today, due to the free email service, there are crores of email users all over the world and the number of these users is increasing day by day.

I am sure with full confidence that you are also an email user. With the help of the internet and mobile phone, you can easily access email service.

2. Easy to Use

Using email is easy and convenient. That is, the email interface is very user-friendly, due to which children and adults can also use it easily. Email is capable of sending any message veryfast. Your email is sent as soon as you click on the send button and within a few seconds your email goes to the inbox of the person to whom you send the email. To use email, you must have an internet connection and devices such as computers, laptops, smartphones, tablets, etc., only then you can send and receive emails. Email allows people to communicate quickly without physical meetings or phone calls, with this feature email is an important communication service today.

3. Global

This is also one of the biggest email advantages because most the people all over the world are used email for messaging today. By which email is a become very popular communication platform at the global level. That is, using email, you can talk to any person in the world.

4. Info at your Fingertips

With Email, information is at your fingertips. In this modern era, an email has become a very important tool for businessmen, which they use to stay connected with their customers as well as keep information on the latest trends and news happening around them. Through email, you can easily know about many topics, for this you have to the subscribe to any website or YouTube channel and as soon as there is some new update on that website or YouTube channel, you will get an email about that update.

5. Send Reminders to yourself

With Email Send reminders to yourself, you can set an email reminder for a specific date and time. You'll also be able to create recurring reminders that will repeat on the specified days of yourchoice. The app has been designed with simplicity in mind so it's easy for anyone to use without any difficulty.

6. Speed

Email provides a very fast messaging service. Email sends the message faster than any other messaging medium. Email sends and receives emails to recipients in seconds, no matter where they are in the world. There are no other services in the world today that send messages as fast as email.

7. Accessibility

Email is very easy to use, any person can use email very easily. Today people use email to do many things such as - some people use email as a storage medium, where people store their important files and documents. So that these important files and documents can be accessed anytime from any corner of the world.

8. Without the Need for Paper

This is one of the most important properties of email that email is a paperless service, that is, we can send messages by writing to anyone without using any paper. An email has all the features so that you can send a good message to someone. You do not need any paper or pen to use the email service.

9. Advertisements

You can also do advertisements through email, this is also a quality of an email. Using this you can promote and sell your product and earn more profit. With this type of marketing, you can promote your product for less money. If you also use email service, then you must have seen advertisements for some company on your email account.

10. Attachments

This is also a very important quality of an email, using which you can add attachments to the mail in addition to text. Using attachments, you can send photos, videos, music, documents, or even a PDF file to someone in an email. Today many people use attachment features.

What are the Disadvantages of Email?

Email has been a convenient way of communicating for many years. However, there are some disadvantages to email that you might not think about.

Impersonal

- Malicious Use
- Information Overload
- Time-Consuming
- Insecure
- Internet Access
- Misunderstandings
- Delete Send Email
- Spamming
- Virus Attacks
- Time-Consuming

1. Impersonal

The first disadvantage of email is that it can be impersonal. Emails can come off as unfriendly and uninterested in the reader. It's also difficult to read someone's body language over email, which makes it hard to gauge how they're feeling or what they're trying to say. This means that you could misinterpret the tone of an email and respond with something that might offend them.

2. Malicious Use

One of the largest disadvantages is that it can be used maliciously. An email can contain malware, which is software that's designed to steal information from you or damage your computer.

3. Information Overload

A major disadvantage of email is that it often leads to information overload. In other words, you might find yourself getting too many emails or newsletters from companies or other businesses.

You might also receive more than enough emails that are irrelevant to your needs and interests.

4. Time-Consuming

Email is a great way to communicate with people but it can be time-consuming. It might take someone who has been working all day 10 minutes to write an email. It might take them another 10 minutes to proofread their email and make sure that there are no spelling or grammar mistakes that may have been missed the first time around.

5. Insecure

We've all received spam emails. And you've probably noticed an email from a friend has been hacked, too. The nature of email, unlike text messages or instant messages, isn't secure since it's sent over an open line. That means that anyone with simple hacking skills can intercept your email and read it.

6. Internet Access

This is the biggest disadvantage of email because without an internet connection you can neither send email to anyone nor can you receive email from anyone. This is not a problem but without an internet connection, you cannot use the email service. You must have an internet connection if you want to use email.

7. Misunderstandings

Email can also be misinterpreted, it also depends on the person and what is the mindset of that person. If you send an email to someone in a hurry and send some wrong type while sending the email, then the person receiving the email takes it seriously. So whenever you send an email to someone, before sending the email, check that email once.

8. Delete Send Email

This is also a big disadvantage of email because when you send an email to someone, you cannot delete that sent email. This is not a matter of concern, but just imagine that you have to send a private email to someone, and if that private email is sent to someone by mistake, then it can be a problem for you.

9. Spamming

If you also use an email service, then you will also get spam emails every day. If you don't use a firewall or anti-spam software, you may have an excessive amount of spam mail in your email inbox.

These spam emails are very annoying, so you have to remove spam emails from time to time. Email spam filters are also not able to stop these spam emails, do not open the spam email because by doing so your email account can also be harmed.

10. Virus Attacks

Virus attack can also happen on your mobile and computer through email, in today's time such virus attack is happening very fast on email users. Virus emails are just normal emails that you cannot recognize.

11. Time-Consuming

In today's time, it takes a lot of time and energy to read, write and respond to any email. Today many people do email work and spend their whole day writing and reading emails. It's boring to write and read emails all-day.

Email Etiquette

Email is how many businesses communicate. It's fast, easy, and accessible. Plus, email is permanent. If you forgot what you were asked, simply find the last email

thread for the answer. Email is also effective at disseminating information among team members. However, there is no way to unsent an email.

So, before pressing send, make sure you're using email as an appropriate form of business communication. Business emails should be used to send information that is:

Relevant: Use email when a quick call or face-to-face conversation won't suffice. Emails should be necessary and relevant to the receiver.

Timely: When time is of essence, email can be the perfect tool. It allows you to send relevant information quickly to everyone on the team.

Content-rich: When file attachments or links to web-based material need to be shared, email is an effective tool to do that.

How you use email will leave an impression with who you send your messages to, especially if you have yet to meet the recipient in person. Email acts as your first impression. This is especially true for job seekers. Using email inappropriately can put you on the "do not call" list with recruiters and others in your network.

Whether you're a small business using email as a marketing or communication tool or a job seeker sending an email inquiry, use appropriate email etiquette to set yourself apart. Here are some Ps and Qs to using email as a business communication tool.

1. Avoid all caps, exclamation points, and slang. Email can be a relaxed way of communicating, making it tempting to add a few exclamation points or using all caps for emphasis. Instead, all caps give the impression you're yelling and too many exclamation points come across as being overly enthusiastic or insincere. Of course, it goes without saying to avoid slang. Included in slang is industry specific jargon unless you're writing to one of your peers.
2. Overuse of bold, underline, and italics void emphasis. While it's OK to use one form of emphasis, such as bold, avoid using multiple forms of emphasis in a single email. That goes for overusing bold, underline, or italics in a single email. Use emphasis to draw the eye from one point to another. Think of emphasized words as creating their own sentence as the reader scans from one bolded word to the next and so on.
3. Be respectful with your tone. Stay positive and professional by avoiding negative or accusatory language. Rephrase sentences to deliver the message in a neutral tone.
4. Be mobile-friendly with short and concise messages. Avoid writing a novel. If you can say it with ten words, see what you can do with five. More than 50% of all emails are misinterpreted, and only 53% are actually read. One third of business professionals check email on their mobile device. That same study showed that seven in ten users will delete emails instantly that don't display correctly on a phone.
5. Be careful when trying to be funny. Humor is subjective. What you might find hilarious, someone else might find incredibly offensive. Remember, email is void of tone, body language, or other non-verbal cues.
6. Salutations and closings should be professional and respectful. It's OK to address your recipient with "good morning, Jane" or "hello." Avoid being too informal, especially if you're seeking a job. Always use the recipient's preferred name. And

close respectfully. Proper closings can include "I look forward to hearing from you," "best," or "thank you."

7. Create a professional signature. Today, all email messages should include a professional signature. Include relevant contact information including job title, company, website, and phone number. If you're a job seeker, including a link to your LinkedIn page is a must. When appropriate include links to your business social pages.

8. Use succinct subject lines. Keep your subject lines to less than 50 characters, or six to ten words. Be descriptive and to the point: Meeting scheduled 6/4/22 at 4PM, 10 reasons to hire an assistant, or nice meeting you yesterday.

9. Respond timely and appropriately. Respond to emails within 24 hours. If your response requires more time, send a quick "I'll get back to you as soon as I can" or, better yet, "I'll get back to you by noon tomorrow." This shows respect for the sender and is always appreciated.

10. Proofread, proofread, proofread. Remember, you cannot unsend an email. Don't make your readers edit your work to understand your message. Double check everything including your message, spelling, grammar, and your signature. Make sure you've attached and/or linked and documents noted in your email. The worst is sending a resume without attaching the resume! (We've all done it so don't berate yourself -it's just a painful lesson in proofing.)

Importance of E-mail: The arrival of a postman at or doorstep has become a rare event. We hardly ever receive a message by post. Electronic mail has rapidly replaced the traditional system of exchanging information and messages. People now prefer to use email to keep in touch with relatives and friends and to communicate for official and business purposes.

Basically an email is a message sent through the internet. You can reach individuals or groups anywhere in the world to share thoughts, information, files of data, spreadsheets and in fact, anything that can be stored in a computer. You can do this even without knowing where the receiver is located. The email address merely indicates the destination to be reached without any details that are given in a postal address. In a way, email combines some of the same time have the advantage of revising the text of the message before transmission. No wonder, a vast majority of business organisations and government offices use email as a tool of communication. In fact, a new online culture of communication has emerged and it is being imbibed quickly by the new workforce with ease and facility.

Though email is not considered a final, legal record, its use has grown enormously. The main reasons for its popularity are as follows:

- Being relatively informal, it is easy and less time-consuming to draft it.
- The transmission of the message is instant.
- Its delivery is confirmed immediately.
- A file or attachment containing hundreds of pages can also be sent with the email.
- The message can be sent to a number of persons at the click of a button.
- The cost is affordable, even small organisations and low income groups can use this facility

- It is time-friendly; you can send and read an email at your convenience any time during the day or night.

STRUCTURE

The structure of an email is essentially like that of a business letter. However, the arrangement of elements is slightly different as described below:

- (i) **From:** Email address of the sender.
- (ii) **Date:** The date and time of sending the message.
- (iii) **To:** Email address of the receiver.
- (iv) **CC:** Email addresses of those to whom the same message is to be sent simultaneously.
- (v) **Subject:** A word or phrase reflecting the main content of the message. This is given when the message is for business or official purposes.
- (vi) **Salutation:** Greeting as a matter of courtesy and to confirm to the sender that the message is for him.
- (vii) **Body:** The message divided into suitable paragraphs.
- (viii) **Leave Taking:** Courteous expression denoting the end of the message.
- (v-card) which contains the following information.
- (ix) **Sign off:** To confirm who the sender is for this purpose. Some people use virtual card which contains the following information.
 - Your name and designation.
 - The organisation to which you belong.
 - Your phone and fax numbers.

3. ESSAY WRITING

2.3 Essay

The word 'essay' is derived from a Latin word 'exagium', which roughly translates to presenting one's case? So essays are a short piece of writing representing one's side of the argument or one's experiences, stories, etc. Essays are very personalized. An essay is generally a short piece of writing outlining the writer's perspective or story. It is often considered synonymous with a story or a paper or an article. Essays can be formal as well as informal. Formal essays are generally academic in nature and tackle serious topics. We will be focusing on informal essays which are more personal and often have humorous elements.

Types of Essays

The type of essay will depend on what the writer wants to convey to his reader. There are broadly four types of essays. Let us see.

- ✓ **Narrative Essays:** This is when the writer is narrating an incident or story through the essay. So these are in the first person. The aim when writing narrative essays is to involve the reader in them as if they were right there when it was happening. So make them as vivid and real as possible. One way to make this possible is to follow the principle of 'show, don't tell'. So you must involve the reader in the story.

2. **Descriptive Essays:** Here the writer will describe a place, an object, an event or maybe even a memory. But it is not just plainly describing things. The writer must paint a picture through his words. One clever way to do that is to evoke the senses of the reader. Do not only rely on sight but also involve the other senses of smell, touch, sound etc. A descriptive essay when done well will make the reader feel the emotions the writer was feeling at the moment.
3. **Expository Essays:** ^{informative} In such an essay a writer presents a balanced study of a topic. To write such an essay, the writer must have real and extensive knowledge about the subject. There is no scope for the writer's feelings or emotions in an expository essay. It is completely based on facts, statistics, examples etc. There are sub-types here like contrast essays, cause and effect essays etc.
4. **Persuasive Essays:** ^{intended or having the power to introduce} Here the purpose of the essay is to get the reader to your side of the argument. A persuasive essay is not just a presentation of facts but an attempt to convince the reader of the writer's point of view. Both sides of the argument have to be presented in these essays. But the ultimate aim is to persuade the readers that the writer's argument carries more weight.

Format of an Essay

Now there is no rigid format of an essay. It is a creative process so it should not be confined within boundaries. However, there is a basic structure that is generally followed while writing essays. So let us take a look at the general structure of an essay.

Introduction

This is the first paragraph of your essay. This is where the writer introduces his topic for the very first time. You can give a very brief synopsis of your essay in the introductory paragraph. Some paragraph writing skills can be a help here. Generally, it is not very long, about 4-6 lines. There is plenty of scope to get creative in the introduction of essays. This will ensure that you hook the reader, i.e. draw and keep his attention. So to do so you can start with a quote or a proverb. Sometimes you can even start with a definition. Another interesting strategy to engage with your reader is to start with a question.

Body

This is the main ^{the most imp. point} crux of your essays. The body is the meat of your essay sandwiched between the introduction and the conclusion. So the most vital and important content of the essay will be here. This need not be confined to one paragraph. It can extend to two or more paragraphs according to the content. Usually, we have a lot of information to provide in the body. And the mistakes writers generally make is to go about it in a haphazard manner which leaves the reader confused. So it is important to organize your thoughts and content. Write the information in a systematic flow so that the reader can comprehend. So, for example, you were narrating an incident. The best manner to do this would be to go in a chronological order.

Conclusion

This is the last paragraph of the essay. Sometimes a conclusion will just mirror the introductory paragraph but make sure the words and syntax are different. A conclusion is also a great place to sum up a story or an argument. You can round up your essay by providing some moral or wrapping up a story. Make sure you complete your essays with the conclusion, leave no hanging threads.

Tips for Essay Writing

- Give your essays an interesting and appropriate title. It will help draw the attention of the reader and pique their curiosity
- Keep it between 300-500 words. This is the ideal length, you can take creative license to increase or decrease it
- Keep your language simple and crisp. Unnecessary complicated and difficult words break the flow of the sentence.
- Do not make grammar mistakes, use correct punctuation and spellings. If this is not done it will distract the reader from the content
- Before beginning the essay organize your thought and plot a rough draft. This way you can ensure the story will flow and not be an unorganized mess.

Process of Writing Essay

If you're writing an essay, research paper, term paper, novel, short story, poem, screenplay, blog article about essay writing—when writing just about anything, really—it's crucial to follow an efficient writing process. Even if you prefer the stream-of-consciousness style for writing your rough draft, you still need to have an orderly system that allows you to revise and hone.

Brainstorming

It always helps to collect your thoughts before you begin writing by brainstorming. Based on your prompt or thesis, try to generate as many ideas as possible to include in your essay. Think of as many as time allows, knowing that you'll be able to set aside the ideas that don't work later.

Preparing

The preparation phase consists of both outlining your essay and collecting resources for evidence. Take a look at the results of your brainstorming session. First, isolate the ideas that are essential to support your thesis and then organize them in a logical and progressive order. In this stage you'll incorporate your essay structure, which we explain below.

Drafting

This is the main stage of essay writing where you roll up your sleeves and actually write your first draft. Remember that everything doesn't have to be perfect; this is your *first* draft, not your *final* draft, so give yourself the freedom to make errors. If you're focusing on getting every single word right, you'll miss the big picture.

Revising

The revisions stage involves your second draft, your third draft, or even your twelfth draft if necessary. Address all the nuances and subtleties you glossed over in the *first* draft. Pay attention to both word choice and clarity, as well as sophisticated writing techniques like avoiding the passive voice. If you're not confident in your writing skills yet, the Grammarly Editor ensures your writing is readable, clear, and concise by offering sentence structure and word choice suggestions, plus clarity revisions as you write. Grammarly helps catch common mistakes with sentence structure—like run-on sentences, sentence fragments, passive voice, and more.

Proofreading

When all the heavy-duty revisions are finished, it's time for the final polish. Go through your essay and correct misspellings, formatting issues, or grammatical errors. This is also where you can turn to Grammarly's AI-powered writing assistant, which helps catch these common mistakes for you. Or copy and paste your writing to check your grammar and get instant feedback on grammar, spelling, punctuation, and other mistakes you might have missed

1. JUMBLED SENTENCES

3.1 PARA- JUMBLES

Para-Jumble as the name refers to a paragraph wherein the sentences of the paragraph are jumbled and are assigned with some number or letter. So, the question is what should we do in para jumble questions? We are required to arrange the sentences in a proper manner such that they link and form a coherent paragraph, and we must do this rearrangement by choosing the appropriate option from the given option. The name of the topic is in a way misleading because we are not jumbling paragraphs here but we are actually straightening out jumbled sentences in a paragraph. This sort of question is quite common in various competitive exams. The right approach to such type of questions can fetch you good marks in competitive exams.

Types of Para Jumbles

Depending upon the pattern of paras and questions, Para Jumbles are of the following types.

General Type: Old Pattern

This type is very common, either 4 or 6 sentences are given in a jumbled manner and you have to arrange them in a proper sequence such that they link and form a coherent paragraph.

Q) Some parts of a sentence have been jumbled up and labelled P, Q, R, and S. Select the option that gives the correct sequence in which these parts can be rearranged to form a meaningful and grammatically correct sentence.

P: Ashish is a good person.

Q: I have a friend

R: He and I are friends for a very long time.

S: His name is Ashish.

Ans: The correct sequence is Q-S-P-R

- ① TRIFU - Fruit
- ② DIFERN - Friend
- ③ INETOC - notice
- ④ FNICODNTE - confident

Fixed Sentences

In this type of questions, the position of few sentences are fixed and you are required to arrange the remaining in a meaningful sequence. The fixed sentence can be the first and the last sentence or any position from the sequence.

Q) In the following question, there are six parts marked S1, S6, P, Q, R and S. The position of S1 and S6 are fixed. Some parts of the sentence have been jumbled up. Rearrange these parts and choose the proper sequence from the given options.

(S1) One hot day, an ant was searching for some water, after walking around for some time, she came to a spring.

(P) While making her way up, she slipped and fell into the water

(Q) To reach the spring, she had to climb up a blade of grass

(R) She could have drowned if a dove up a nearby tree had not seen her

(S) Seeing that the ant was in trouble, the dove quickly plucked a leaf and dropped it into the water near the struggling ant

(S6) The ant moved towards the leaf and climbed up onto it, and the leaf drifted to dry ground, and the ant jumped out, and she was safe at last.

Ans: The correct sequence is Q-P-R-S.

- 1) very / became / dinosaurs / heavy / the
- 2) in / every year / people / this way / die
- 3) but / alternative / be / a / could / fine

Practice Questions

Adjectives like 'simpler', 'better', 'cleverer' etc. are comparative. Hence they always hold a relation to other things. Such adjectives can also be of good help in solving Para Jumbles.

1. Here I would like to echo the words of former President of India, Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, "A nation's progress depends about how its people think."
 2. We have to act with conviction to realize our dream.
 3. We Indians have to think as a nation and dream to transform our country into a super power.
 4. It is very unfortunate that economically ^{rising again} resurgent India still remains home to the world's largest population of poor, hungry and illiterate people.
 5. Besides these, rapidly increasing population, rampant corruption, exploitation of women, child labour, communalism are some of the ^{unrestrained and violent} issues which need to be worked upon.
 6. Tragically, hunger remains India's biggest lingering problem with an estimated 7000 Indians dying of hunger every single day. ^{the act of delay}
 7. Along with chronic hunger, deep poverty and high illiteracy also continue to blight the lives of millions of our people. ^{cause to suffer}
1. A-B-C-D-E-F-G
 2. B-C-D-A-F-E-G
 3. ☒ D-F-G-E-A-C-B
 4. D-C-G-B-F-E-A

Ans: The correct sequence is D-F-G-E-A-C-B. Central theme: Problems faced by Indians

Tips to Solve Para Jumbles

Each Para Jumble can make use of one or more of these tips for solving. Do note that these tips should be applied depending on the unique Para Jumble question posed to you. Some problems can be solved by taking articles as a clue, while some may need pronouns as a guide. Here are a few tips to successfully solve Para Jumbles:

1. Identifying the Opening Statement

Look for the sentence that clearly introduces a person, place, committee, or concept in the Para Jumble. That will most likely be the opening sentence.

Example: 1. He was looking forward to opening up the presents in the solitude of his room.

2. Sanjay's birthday was celebrated with a big bash.
3. But the guests insisted he open them up right there.
4. Several people arrived at his home bearing gifts, both big and small.

Introductory Line: Clearly the first line must be statement B. This is because the whole passage talks about gifts and guests and what happens at birthdays. So the first sentence must necessarily introduce the person whose birthday it is. He is referred to by his name in this sentence whereas the remaining sentences refer to him as 'he'. This is another indication that sentence B is the opening line.

2. Identifying Central Theme: Always spot the central theme of each Para Jumble. The flow of the story/dialogue goes a long way in piecing together the paragraph in the correct order.
3. Follow the Activities: At times, the Para Jumble will have sentences talking about activities. In such cases by just analyzing which activity happens when the question can be solved very easily.

Example:

1. He accumulates some capital and goes into a business venture with his sons.
 2. In order to increase his salary he works through the night.
 3. They open a shop to create men's garments.
 4. Later he takes the garments and sells it on New York's streets.
 5. He takes garments from the sweatshop to finish at home with the help of his wife and older children at night.
 6. A Russian tailor artisan comes to America, takes to the needle trade, works in sweatshop for small salary.
1. F-E-B-D-A-C
 2. B-C-D-A-F-E
 3. D-F-E-A-C-B
 4. D-C-B-F-E-A

Ans: The correct sequence is F-E-B-D-A-C. Central theme: The struggle of a tailor and his steps to success.

2. READING COMPREHENSION

TYPES OF READING SKILLS SKIMMING

What is Skimming?

Skimming is a reading technique that allows readers to get the gist of a text without having to read the whole thing in full. The main purpose is to get an idea of what the text is about. For e.g., when we read a newspaper, we are actually skimming. We do not read every word- instead we skim it to get a general idea of what main articles are about. We might use headlines, photographs and captions to help us decide if we want to delve further into a particular article or skip it and search further.

Skimming involves three main skills:

- i) Identifying the central idea
- ii) Recognizing main ideas
- iii) Identifying the writing patterns of the passage/text

Let us briefly see the techniques of skimming for better understanding of the content we read.

Techniques of Skimming

Read the title- it is the shortest summary of the content.

Read the introduction or lead-in paragraph

Read the first paragraph completely

If there are sub-headings, read each one, looking for relationship among them

Read the first sentence of each remaining paragraph

a) the main idea of paragraphs appears in the first sentence

b) if author's pattern is to begin with a question or anecdote, you may find the last sentence more valuable.

Skimming and scanning are two reading techniques that help individuals quickly gather information from a text without reading it word by word. These techniques are particularly useful when you need to locate specific information or get an overview of the content.

When to use skimming

Skimming has always been one of the most selected ways when it comes to fast reading. Before putting any effort into studying a document, practicing skimming can be a good Skimming or a long article. Most people refer Time-saving has been to the point starting a new chapter to use of skimming when they need to save time. It has always been one of the top priorities of today's society. Reading every word can prevent being or reading speed. There are many. Reading every spending long hours of laborious reading can't do anything well. If you have to read an academic text and write an essay about its topic, skimming can't do all the job as there is too much information. This skill would help when you're trying to find out if something is a waste of time or similar to something else you've already known. Using skimming is an ideal approach when there are only a few days left and you're about to take an examination. In short, you save your time by skimming.

Example 1

Directions: Skim through the passage and the questions given below in 30 seconds. You may use the guideline given in the preceding discussion. After predicting the content, encircle the most appropriate answer for each question.

Passage

The food we eat seems to have profound effects on our health. Although science has made enormous steps in making food fit to eat, it has, at the same time, made many foodstuffs unfit to eat. Some research has shown that perhaps eighty per cent of all human illnesses are related to diet and forty per cent of cancer is related to the diet as well, especially cancer of the colon. People of different cultures are more prone to contract certain illnesses because of the characteristic foods they consume.

That food is related to illness is not a new discovery. In 1945, government researchers realized that nitrates and nitrites (commonly used to preserve colour in meats) as well as other food additives caused cancer. Yet, these carcinogenic additives remain in our food, and it becomes more difficult all the time to know which ingredients on the packaging labels of processed food are helpful or harmful.

The additives that we eat are not all so direct. Farmers often give penicillin to cattle and poultry, of this, penicillin has been found in the milk of treated cows. Sometimes, similar drugs are administered to animals not for medicinal purposes, but for financial reason. The farmers are simply trying to fatten the animals in order to obtain a higher price in the market. In spite of the Food and Drug Administration, the practices continue.

A healthy diet is directly related to good health. Often, we are unaware of detrimental substances we ingest. Sometimes, well-meaning farmers or others who do not realize consequences add these substances to food without our knowledge.

SCANNING

What is Scanning?

Scanning is the act of searching for particular information in a text with a particular approach. It is a distinct strategy involving rapid but focused reading of text in order to locate specific information, rather than trying to absorb all the information. It is a skill that grows

rapidly with practice. In scanning you have a question in your mind and you read a passage only to find the answer, ignoring unrelated information. For instance, if you want to know the meaning of the word 'virtuous' from a dictionary, you will start searching the letter V first, then I, and then R; by then you probably will have found the word. This process of searching is called scanning. It is a technique of fast reading.

Techniques of Scanning

1. State the specific information you are looking for.
2. Try to anticipate how the answer will appear and what clues you might use to help you locate the answer. For example, if you were looking for a certain date, you would quickly read the paragraph looking only for numbers.
3. Use headings and any other aids that will help you identify which sections might contain the information you are looking for
4. Selectively read and skip through sections of the passage.

When to use Scanning

As convenient as it seems, skimming can't guarantee you all the important points. Usually you need scanning when you find a friend's phone number on your mobile phone or the previous night's cricket's scores in the newspaper. Or when you're in a new restaurant knowing they have your favourite dish but not sure the price is reasonable, you also need to scan along the menu to see it with the price. Scanning significantly proves its value when researching and studying. These two kinds of activity can't be successful if they depend on only your general knowledge. You may also need scanning to locate the correct answer for the given questions. You likely to scan when you have no intention of getting a general idea. Obviously, if you have no doubt of your purposes for reading and other unrelated information is far from supposed then take scanning into your consideration. Scanning is perfect when it comes to look for something more particular rather than an overview idea in your mind.

Difference between Skimming and Scanning

Basis for comparison	Skimming	Scanning
Meaning	Skimming is a way of reading something in a fast manner so as to grasp the main points.	Scanning means to look carefully and quickly at the written material so as to locate something.
Method of Reading Involves	Quick	Selective
Involves	Reading out the maximum content in minimum time.	Finding out the required data.
Objective	To take a birds-eye view of the text.	To spot and cast specific facts.
Familiarity	The reader is not familiar with the text.	The reader knows what he is searching

1. Skimming:

- **Purpose:** Skimming is used to quickly grasp the main ideas and overall structure of a text.
- **Technique:** When skimming, you don't read every word. Instead, you glance over the text, reading headings, subheadings, the first and last sentences of paragraphs, and any highlighted or emphasized text. You might also read the introduction and conclusion.
- **Speed:** Skimming is a fast reading technique that allows you to get a sense of the content without delving into details.
- **Use Cases:** Skimming is useful when you want to decide if a text is worth reading in-depth, find the main points of a long article or book, or quickly review a document before a meeting or presentation.

2. Scanning:

- **Purpose:** Scanning is used to locate specific information within a text, such as a particular name, date, number, or keyword.
- **Technique:** When scanning, you move your eyes quickly across the text in a systematic manner, searching for the specific information you need. You're not concerned with understanding the entire content; instead, you're looking for particular details.
- **Speed:** Scanning is even faster than skimming since you're solely focused on finding specific items.
- **Use Cases:** Scanning is handy when you're searching for a phone number in a directory, locating a particular section in a textbook, or searching for key terms in a research paper.

Differences between skimming and scanning:

- **Purpose:** Skimming provides an overview of the text's main ideas and structure, while scanning is used to pinpoint specific information within the text.
- **Technique:** Skimming involves quickly reading selected parts of the text, while scanning involves a rapid visual search for specific words or information.
- **Speed:** Scanning is typically faster than skimming, as it focuses solely on finding specific details.
- **Use Cases:** Skimming is useful for previewing or reviewing content, while scanning is used for finding specific facts or data.

Tips for Skimming:

This particular technique would be applied to various instances:

- Have a look at the table of contents first.
- While reviewing the subheadings in each chapter.
- If in case you need to have a quick read of the first paragraph in that section.

Tips for Scanning:

- You don't need to read every word. Just look for the information you want.
- Again, use headings, sub-headings, bullet points or key words to guide you.

3.3 Cloze Test

3. CLOZE TEST

A Cloze test is a sentence completion test. Candidates are required to make a choice from multiple alternatives for each word blanked out, not in a sentence but in the passage. Such types of questions are asked to check the candidate's vocabulary power and the ability to understand the passage as a whole is assessed. Mainly 4-8 questions are asked from the cloze test topic in the exams, especially SSC, Bank, Insurance, and RRB exams. Candidates can score good marks easily in this section with sound reading aptitude. In this article, A few tips are discussed which may help you to tackle the cloze test questions, and for that, a sample passage is given for your reference.

For Example

Q 1. There are _____ books on computer science in your school library, so you need to purchase them from the market.

- a). a few
- b). a little
- c). few
- d). the few

Answer: option c

Explanation:

Here option c will be the correct choice because "few" is used when we talk about a small quantity.

Cloze Test Tricks:

A passage consists of sentences that are logically related to one another. First of all, read the passage, try to get an idea of the content of the passage, and keep it in the background of your mind.

- Use the following tips to solve the cloze test.
 1. If you know the answer, immediately tick the correct answer.
 2. When you do not know the answer exactly, make the right choice through the process of elimination.

Elimination Technique:

- Step 1: Check the words if any of them does not fit into the structure (eliminate it).
- Step 2: Analyse which of them does not fit in with the meaning (eliminate).
- Step 3: Apply your awareness to the remaining options of the usage of words.
- Step 4: Try finding out a clue in the sentence. Sometimes the clue is hidden in the next sentence or some sentences away.
- Step 5: Even now, if the final answer is not reached, apply your logical skill and repeat step to reach the correct option.

① He has lived in Patna _____ four years.
 a) since b) before c) for d) after

②